

Satan: The Father of All Iniquity

We have been beginning in Ezekiel, and this revelation keeps flowing through me. At the same time, when there is something God wants to say, as you know, He has been dropping it with the mind of Christ, and I have been prophesying out of it. That has been happening more frequently since we are crossing this line and going behind this next door, however you want to speculate.

If He comes and takes me away, I eventually will get through this teaching.

Hallelujah.

We found out that God was isolating the seat of Satan, much like He would do now. He might say, "Hitler, I know your works," and in the same breath switch over and let Satan know He knows where he is seated, who he is working through, and what he is doing.

Whenever Satan comes to full power in a nation, that nation always tries to conquer the world. It is an old, old story: Japan, Rome, Germany. It is the death nature.

When Scripture says Jesus destroyed him who had the power of death, even the devil, the power Satan had was to reign over you with death because it was in your nature, like his. When Jesus came, He destroyed him who had the power of death by taking that old nature out of you and giving you one Satan cannot reign over anymore.

So God says, "I know where you are." He did that to the king of Tyre.

Ezekiel 28:9 says:

Wilt thou yet say before him that slayeth thee, I am God?

Does that not sound pathetic? "Will you say before Him who slays you, I am God?"

Then:

But thou shalt be a man, and no God, in the hand of him that slayeth thee.

Then verse 12 tells you who He is really talking about:

Son of man, take up a lamentation upon the king of Tyrus, and say unto him, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Thou sealest up the sum, full of wisdom, and perfect in beauty.

Verse 13:

Thou hast been in Eden the garden of God.

Every precious stone was his covering: sardius, topaz, diamond, beryl, onyx, jasper, sapphire, emerald, carbuncle, and gold. The workmanship of his tabrets and pipes was prepared in him the day he was created.

Verse 14:

Thou art the anointed cherub that covereth; and I have set thee so.

He was upon the holy mountain of God and walked up and down in the midst of the stones of fire.

Verse 15:

Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.

We found out that God had Eden, the Garden of God. We should not be surprised that He would make us a little house to live in like His. At that time Satan was Lucifer, the anointed cherub that covered. He was put into that garden for the same reason Adam was put into ours: to dress it.

He was perfect in his ways from the day he was created until iniquity was found in him.

Jesus said in John 8 that there is no truth in him, that he is the father of lies, the father of it. When Jesus said he is the father of it, not just the father of all liars, He meant Satan fathered all iniquity. Anything that comes out of it originated with him.

Yet when Lucifer was created, he was perfect. In the beginning of our creation, Jesus said he was a liar from the beginning. So He was not talking about Lucifer's beginning. He was talking about the beginning we know and understand to exist: our planet, universe, and galaxy.

Before there was a Milky Way, before anything we know to have a beginning had a beginning, Lucifer was already out there. We do not know how many millions of years. It does not matter. They do not live on our time scale. We do. We just know he was perfect when he was created until iniquity was found in him.

The early world was not just a story you read and refer to. It was a whole world. It was not until compassion began to take me, and until the foot went behind the door of the Father in private worship, that I could open the conduit and let love flow from His Spirit to mine.

That love heightened the new nature He gave me. As that love magnified in that nature, I was able to look at God and understand actions He would take in love. Before that, to get a peek into the early world, you could forget it.

When I found out the voice of grace He leaves in a person's life, and how much mercy and tender lovingkindness He has, His love heightened the nature He gave me. Then I could look at Him and understand certain moves He made that I could not make sense of before.

When Jesus began to outline the nature of God, He pointed to the Twelve and taught them: do good to those who hate you, pray for those who spitefully use you, if a man takes away your goods give him your cloak also, if he slaps you on one cheek turn the other also. Then He said, "Be merciful as your Father is merciful."

Imagine Him standing up and teaching that to a Jewish nation with a history of war, a nation that had seen God go ahead of them in vengeance and give them victory time after time. You wonder what the Jews thought as He taught them about the heavenly Father with this nature.

It seems diametrically opposed if you try to understand the compassion and relationship God has with us, then look at what He did in the Old Testament. Sometimes you can develop a vengeance-holiness kind of view: "You fool with me, and I will turn you over to the devil."

The first time He used me in any kind of judgment, He preceded it by telling me, "You are becoming a little bit qualified. I need to do this." He did not really use me to speak words. He took me on the journey with Him and judged someone, and wanted me to tell him. For some reason, He needed me.

I think that is one reason Paul turned that man over who had his father's wife. But do you want to know what the qualification ended up being to be used in judgment? Mercy that rejoices against judgment.

I do not know how many billions of people were on the planet before the flood. There are six billion on ours, and it is being taxed. We do know the earth was heavily populated.

Their history lasted two thousand years. A whole world lived and died in two thousand years, in eight chapters.

Would you believe God has been taking me back there and showing me His compassion? I did not want to bring this out here, but it kept coming up until I finally went and got it.

This is just the introduction to the letter I am working on about the ark and the flood. I want you to imagine you got this letter and knew nothing about it. These first eight pages have to grip you enough that you will want to read a letter as thick as ours is.

I always write to somebody. In this case, I have Tim in front of me. If I do not, I end up writing to myself, and then you have to climb into my head to understand it. That is why I keep somebody else in front of me all the time.

Brother Tim, once again God has been faithful to teach me more about His mercy and tender lovingkindness in the way He had to deal with the Old Testament saints, in particular the people before the flood in Noah's day.

I guess I did not know God as well as I thought I did until I began to use the new nature He gave me to help me understand things about Him that are contained within His nature.

When you hear someone say, "That person really has a good nature," the reason they say that is because the person always does things a certain way. They never act out of character; therefore they are predictable. If they do act out of character, the same person will say, "That is not like them. Something must have really happened to cause them to act like that."

Tim, God had to step out of character to deal with the Old Testament saints and the peoples before the flood. Although He loved them, His fellowship with them was limited by their sin natures. The people before the flood left Him no other recourse but to judge them.

When I said I did not know God as well as I thought I did, I meant that it was not until I broke into private worship and found out my spirit had within it an unlimited capacity to pool and reservoir the love of God that I understood God's love. The part of me that could contain it was the new nature He gave me when I was born again and made a partaker of His divine nature.

Private worship seemed to be the conduit that carried God's love from His Spirit to mine. As His love increased, I became increasingly aware of the side of God Jesus often referred to as the Father. The more His love increased in my nature, the more I could understand how love operated in His nature. It helped me understand certain actions God had to take at different times that seemed against His nature and out of character.

I marveled at the longsuffering of God as He held on to the people before the flood, showing mercy and making every attempt to spare them, striving to hold on to them as the whole world slipped into darkness and turned itself over to sin.

But my amazement toward those people before the flood and the longsuffering of God was nothing compared to the amazement I felt toward God when I found out their final outcome and what happened to them in the final moments of their lives as the waters reached critical mass and began to drown them.

The love I uncovered in God's nature shook me to the core of my being.

Come with me into Genesis and the Scriptures leading up to those final moments, and let me show you His mercy.

Just eight chapters describe the rise and fall of a whole world. They were people living just like us. Jesus described them as eating, drinking, marrying, and being given in marriage until the day Noah entered the ark.

Millions came to the same age and the same kind of moment you are living right now: thinking thoughts, laughing, having families, living and dying in eight chapters spanning two millennia.

What happened to them? What was the fate of a whole world that died in a flood? What was the fate of the children?

Peter had the revelation of how the cross affected the outcome of these people. Speaking of Jesus' death and resurrection in 1 Peter 3:18-21, he said:

For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit:

By which also he went and preached unto the spirits in prison;

Which sometime were disobedient, when once the longsuffering of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was a preparing, wherein few, that is, eight souls were saved by water.

The like figure whereunto even baptism doth also now save us... by the resurrection of Jesus Christ.

The rest of the letter breaks that down.

First of all, what happened to the children? There is no way to tell how many millions of children were alive on the planet when the flood came. Because all children under the age of accountability are born in a state of innocence and are not accountable for the nature they are born with, the millions of children who died before and during the flood are part of the billions of children who have died in innocence since the beginning of time, all the way to our present day.

But it was not until the fulfillment of 1 Peter 3:18, when Jesus once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that He was able to return for the children who died in the flood.

When this is over, I may be able to say that a baptism of love is starting to happen. When you are baptized into something, you are submerged into it. Are you able to talk about anything else?

God had a garden, a house He lived in. We are His sons and daughters, so why would He not make a little Garden of Eden just like His? He put Adam in it to dress it.

One thing we overlook is that if there was a Tree of Life in our garden, there must have been one in His. I know Lucifer's fall had something to do with it.

Go to Genesis 2:6:

But there went up a mist from the earth, and watered the whole face of the ground.

What a world. What a house.

Verse 7:

And the LORD God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul.

Verse 8:

And the LORD God planted a garden eastward in Eden; and there he put the man whom he had formed.

Verse 9:

And out of the ground made the LORD God to grow every tree that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food...

Then there is a pause:

...the tree of life also in the midst of the garden, and the tree of knowledge of good and evil.

When you look at that, one of the first theological questions people ask is, "Why did God put it there?" They conclude He wanted to test us, that creation had to pass some test. Why would God put a tree in the garden and then say, "Stay away from it"? Would He do that just to see if you would stay away from it?

Lucifer is the father of all iniquity and all lies, meaning it was found in him. How many millions or billions of years ago that was, I do not care. It all originated with him.

So before we judge the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil and say God planted it there as a test, we have to ask: when God called it a tree, what was He calling it?

In Ezekiel, the boughs and form of a tree were so beautiful that all the other trees in the garden envied him. What are we talking about here? Symbolism?

Before we go further, go to Genesis 3:

Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made.

Serpents are strange little creatures. They are a stick with a mouth, and that mouth runs around eating things. No arms or anything, just a mouth.

The serpent was more subtle, deceptively wise, cunning, and crafty, than any beast of the field. He said to the woman:

Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?

Is that not interesting?

People say the snake used to be beautiful, and when God cursed him to eat the dust, He took his arms off. People really believe that? I heard one man say he could tell why Eve ate the apple: she was so shocked to see a standing talking snake that she just reached out and took it. I had to pull over. I thought he was going to give the punch line any minute. There was no punch line. It was pure teaching.

Maybe this is symbolism. If the serpent had arms, I can see him leaning over the fence with a cup of Starbucks having an intellectual discussion with Bessie the cow and the other beasts of the field.

The reason God said this tree was in the midst of the garden is because at that point Satan had not gone to his last incarceration. It seems as though he was judged in stages. First, he was thrown out of heaven. Then, in our creation, he still had that reign where he could run back and forth. The next time he is judged, he will get a taste of incarceration for a thousand years, and then he will go back for eternity, along with everyone who follows him.

His judgment seems to take place on levels.

I know this about God, with the nature He has: He hangs on to you. He hangs on until whatever is in you breaks away from Him. Something may have beaten you into that place, but it is still your choice. He will hang on and reach past everything He can to get to you.

I know He would not be different toward any other creation He has created anywhere.

So what God was doing was warning: "Look, there is a tree in the midst of this garden. I created him. He was in My garden at one time. Now he is in the midst of your garden. Do not eat his fruit, because suddenly you will know evil."

When God came to visit Adam again, He asked, "Adam, where art thou?" One preacher said He did not mean where Adam was, because God knew he was hiding behind a bush. He meant, "Where are you spiritually?" He wanted to show Adam what he had done.

God asked, "Who told you that you were naked? Did you eat the fruit?"

This is my point about the nature. The new nature is not statistical, but it is moral. It knows what is right. It does not have to be taught what is right.

When somebody says, "I was living with this person, but I did not think it was wrong," you knew it was wrong after you were saved. You knew. Usually people say that to justify their standing, to make themselves acceptable in people's eyes. But you know. The quicker you face the fact that you know, the more you can work on the outer limbs of the conscience that turn into the leadership of the Spirit.

My nature is not statistical. I can go into a town, not have your address, and I cannot reach down inside and pull that address up from my own person. I am limited, a single human being limited to myself and what I learn.

But I do have an outside source inside me, and that is the Holy Spirit. He is statistical. He knows everything, can show you everything, can help you through every problem, and He loves fellowshiping with you.

If you are going to make a fortune, He wants you to know that lying in bed until noon every day, confessing you have a million dollars, having coffee, talking to your friends about how good God is, and then going back to bed will not bring your million.

You know what He likes? He likes you to go in and mix it up with rich businessmen, make better deals, get wealthier than them, and then tell them who you know.

Because I am a preacher and you are in a building, I am called to do this to you. I did the same thing until I was thirty. I ran around reaching people. I tried to reach everybody and made them sick and mad at me. But they would not fire me because I did the work of two men and never missed a day.

We would go to break, and they would be smoking. Some of them had their little bottles hidden, a mill town thirty years ago. One of them said, "If you are so smart, what keeps hell burning?"

I said, "All you alcoholics."

I pretty much did what I wanted because I worked hard, and they kept offering me promotions. I would not take them because I knew I was going to go full-time any month. I did, six months after taking the last promotion. I was trying to be fair. They wanted to train me, and I told them I was going to leave, so I would not take their money.

You start reaching people. Do you think the people in your workplaces are less important than you? I am called to do this to you. You are called to do this to them. How are you going to do it unless God mixes you up with them?

You do not just have a job. God wants to make you rich right in the middle of them, if you can receive it, because He knows that if your heart is in your first call, He can give you money.

Are you there just for money? Then you are there for the wrong reason. God would love to make you a millionaire if He can fellowship with you along the way.

I am called to do this to you. You say, "You are a preacher, so you preach." I am not the only one here. You are my work. If I were out there, I would do the same thing to them. I would live right on the line of their restrictions.

God says, "This tree is here. I created him, and he has moved into this creation. Do not eat."

If you want to understand more about how strong the temptation was, look at the Second Adam after a forty-day fast and what He withstood in the wilderness.